ISLAMIC HISTORY AND CIVILIZATION

Faculty of Islamic Studies

DIHPE - Dow University of Health Sciences (DUHS)

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THE RASHIDUN CALIPHATE
EXPANSION OF ISLAMIC RULE

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THE RASHIDUN CALIPHATE

- The Rashidun Caliphate, meaning "Rightly Guided Caliphs," refers to the first four caliphs.
- These caliphs are companions of the Prophet (SAW) and were known for their close association with him.
- The four Rashidun Caliphs were Hazrat Abu Bakar Siddique (RA), Hazrat Umar ibn al-Khattab (RA), Hazrat Uthman ibn Affan (RA), and Hazrat Ali ibn Abi Talib (RA).
- The Rashidun Caliphate marked the era immediately following the demise of the Holy Prophet Muhammad (SAW) in 632 CE.
- It is known for its expansion of Islamic rule and the establishment of key Islamic institutions.

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HAZRAT ABU BAKAR SIDDIQUE (RA)

LIFE BEFORE KHILAFAT

Noble Birth

- Hazrat Abu Bakr ibn Abu Quhafa (RA) was Born into a noble Quraish family in Makkah, Hazrat Abu Bakr (RA) was two years and three months younger than the Prophet Muhammad (SAW). His father was Usman, known as Abu Qahafa, and his mother was Salma, known as Umm-ul-Khair. They shared a common ancestor, Murra.

Childhood Friendship

- Hazrat Abu Bakr (RA) and the Prophet Muhammad (SAW) were close friends from childhood, maintaining a strong bond throughout their lives.

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- Hazrat Abu Bakr (RA) was named, Abdul Kabah, which the Holy Prophet (SAW) changed with Abdullah when he embraced Islam.
- He was the first one to accept the Holy Prophet's statement regarding Mi'raj, ascension to heavens, and for this, the Holy Prophet (SAW) named him, 'As-Siddique', the most truthful, sincere in faith, and not having even the slightest doubt.
- He was also among the ten companions promised Paradise by the Prophet (SAW).

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SERVICES TO ISLAM

Uniting The Muslim Ummah

- Hazrat Abu Bakr (RA) assumed the office of Khilafat at a critical moment in Islamic history.
- Disunity among Muslims, the rise of false prophets, and rebellions threatened the young Islamic state.
- He brought unity among Muslims, crushed the power of false prophets, and put an end to rebellions at home and abroad.
- His leadership laid a foundation of unity and strength for Islam.

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Global Expansion of Islam

- Hazrat Abu Bakr's leadership transformed Islam into a global force.
- He successfully confronted the might of the Persian and Byzantine Empires, expanding the influence of Islam beyond Arabia.
- His strategic vision and decisive actions contributed to the spread and establishment of Islam as a major world religion.

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Preservation of the Quran

- After the Battle of Yamama, where many reciters of the Quran were martyred, Hazrat Abu Bakr (RA) took crucial steps to preserve the Quran.
- He instructed Ziad bin Sabit (RA), one of the scribes of the Prophet Muhammad (SAW), to collect and compile the written copies of the Quran from the companions of the Prophet (SAW) and arrange them in the form of a book.
- This compilation ensured the preservation of the word of Allah for the guidance of mankind till eternity.

Hazrat Abu Bakr's contributions were instrumental in not only saving Islam from disintegration but also in making it a dominant global force, ensuring its survival, growth, and preservation for future generations.

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HAZRAT UMAR FAROOQ (RA)

LIFE BEFORE KHILAFAT

Family and Early Life

- Hazrat Umar ibn Al-Khattab (RA) was born in Makkah approximately twelve or thirteen years after the birth of the Prophet Muhammad (SAW).
- He and the Prophet (SAW) shared a common ancestor, Ka'ab.
- His father, Al-Khattab, was an educated and prosperous merchant who taught him reading and writing.
- Hazrat Umar (RA) was known for his intelligence, studious nature, and strength. He excelled in poetry, oratory, archery, horse-riding, and wrestling.

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Idol Worship and Opposition to Islam

- Initially, Hazrat Umar Farooq (RA) was an idol-worshipper and, along with his father, opposed the Prophet Muhammad (SAW) when he declared his prophethood. They became enemies of the Prophet (SAW) due to their disbelief in his message.

Acceptance Of Islam

- Hazrat Umar (RA) embraced Islam in the 6th year of prophethood. Being a powerful and influential man, he strengthened Islam. His acceptance was a source of protection for the poor and weak Makkans. A few Muslims became bold enough to pray openly in Makkah.
- The Holy Prophet (SAW) gave him the title of Farooq, 'one who distinguishes right from wrong.'
- He was also among the ten companions promised Paradise by the Prophet (SAW).

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SERVICES TO ISLAM

Military Campaigns and Expansion

- During his ten-year Khilafat from 634 to 644 A.D., Hazrat Umar (RA) led military campaigns against the Persians and Romans who wanted to destroy the Islamic state.
- Under his leadership, Muslims overpowered the Byzantine Empire in the West and the Persian Empire in the East, expanding the territory of Islam.

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Administrative Reforms

- Hazrat Umar (RA) implemented efficient administrative reforms to consolidate the conquered territories.
- He enforced the Shariat Law, organized censuses, established the Muslim era of Hijra, constructed forts on the frontiers, and established the department of finance.
- These reforms strengthened the Islamic state and improved governance.

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Social and Economic Reforms

- Hazrat Umar (RA) introduced reforms in agriculture and the life of farmers, improving their livelihoods.
- He also patronized female education, highlighting his commitment to social welfare and education.
- His selfless devotion to the interests of Islam and his contributions to its expansion, governance, and societal well-being earned him an esteemed place in Islamic history.

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HAZRAT USMAN GHANI (RA)

Life Before Khilafat

Family and Early Life

- Hazrat Usman ibn Affan(RA) was born in Makkah, five years younger than the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH).
- He belonged to the Umayyad tribe and shared a common ancestor, Abd Manaf, with the Prophet (SAW).
- His father, Affan, was a wealthy merchant among the Quraish.
- Hazrat Usman (RA) was known for his literacy, learning, and virtuous character even before accepting Islam.

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Conversion to Islam

- Hazrat Usman (RA) was one of the early converts to Islam among the Umayyads. He led a chaste life, abstaining from alcohol, gambling, and idol worship. He spent much time in the company of the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) and was among the ten companions promised Paradise by the Prophet.

Marriage

- The Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) married his second daughter, Hazrat Ruqayya (RA), to Hazrat Usman (RA), and after her death, he married his third daughter, Hazrat Kulsum (RA), to him. Because of this, Hazrat Usman(RA) was known as "Zun Nurain" or the Possessor of Two Lights.
- The Prophet (SAW) expressed such satisfaction with Hazrat Usman (RA) that he remarked he would have married him to another daughter if he had one.

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SERVICES TO ISLAM

Standardization of the Quran

- Hazrat Usman's (RA) most significant service to Islam was the standardization of the Quranic text.
- He noticed variations in recitation among Muslims in newly conquered territories whose mother tongue was not Arabic.
- To ensure uniformity, Hazrat Usman (RA) ordered the transcription of official copies of the Quran from the original compiled in the time of Hazrat Abu Bakr (RA).
- Copies were sent to various parts of the Muslim Empire, and incorrect copies were collected and destroyed, ensuring the preservation of the Quran in its original form.

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LOVE FOR MUSLIMS AND SOLIDARITY

- Hazrat Usman's love for Muslims and the solidarity of Islam was profound.
- He demonstrated this by sacrificing his life rather than taking up the sword against his Muslim brothers, emphasizing his commitment to unity and peace within the Muslim community.

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HAZRAT ALI AL-MURTAZA (RA)

Life before Khilafat

Family and Early Life

- Hazrat Ali ibn Abi Talib (RA) was the first cousin of the Holy Prophet Muhammad (SAW) and the son of Abu Talib, who was the uncle of the Prophet (SAW). He was born in Makkah, and the Prophet (SAW) took him under his care and protection at a young age. He accompanied the Prophet (SAW) on trade journeys to Syria and was ten years old when the Prophet (SAW) received prophethood.

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Conversion to Islam and Learning

- Hazrat Ali (RA) was the second person to embrace Islam.
- He learned to read and write at a young age and became very learned over time.
- He memorized the revelations received by the Prophet (SAW) and kept a written record of his teachings.
- He was also among the ten companions promised Paradise by the Prophet (SAW).

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Relationship with the Prophet (SAW)

- When the Prophet (SAW) migrated from Makkah to Madinah in 622 AD, he entrusted all the valuables given to him by the people of Makkah to Hazrat Ali (RA) for safekeeping. Hazrat Ali (RA) diligently returned these valuables to their rightful owners before joining the Prophet (SAW) in Madinah. The Prophe(SAW) declared him as his brother during the ritual of Muwakhat and married his youngest daughter, Syeda Fatima Tul Zhra (RA), to him.
- He was known for his bravery and was called Asadullah, meaning Lion of God. The Prophet (SAW) gave him the title of 'Abu Turab' meaning father of dust. (when he found Hazrat Ali (RA) sleeping while covered with dust)
- The Holy Prophet (SAW) said that “I am the city of knowledge and Ali is its gate”

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Consultation and Leadership

- The first three Khalifas held Hazrat Ali (RA) in high esteem and consulted him on all important religious and administrative matters. They made him their deputy on various occasions. Hazrat Ali (RA), on his part, cooperated with them and gave them best advice.
- He supported Hazrat Usman (RA) during his Khalifat and ordered his sons to protect Hazrat Usman when he was surrounded by rebels.

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SERVICES IN ISLAM

- During his Khilafat, Hazrat Ali (RA) faced civil wars, which limited his ability to focus on administration and conquests.
- However, he maintained the administrative framework established by the previous Khalifas without making significant changes.
- He paid special attention to the army's needs, building fortresses and cantonments and safeguarding the state treasury.
- He ensured justice in his administration, monitored market prices, and took care of non-Muslims under his rule.

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LEGACY AND HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE OF THE RASHIDUN CALIPHATE'S EXPANSION

- The Rashidun Caliphate's expansion was important for Islamic history and the world. It set the stage for the Islamic Empire to grow big, covering lots of land across three continents.
- These conquests helped Islamic culture and knowledge spread, leading to a vibrant Islamic civilization.
- The time of the Rashidun Caliphate is seen as a great example of fair and good governance, which inspired later Islamic leaders.

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THANK YOU

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